

SUPERSEDED - DO NOT USE FOR CROSS-PAIR ORDERING

This figure asserts a severity-ordered separation, Control-Severe as the largest contrast, and agreement between MMD and energy distance. All three claims are WITHDRAWN.

The MMD bandwidth was calibrated separately per pair, placing the three magnitudes in different reproducing-kernel Hilbert spaces. The energy distance used a biased V-statistic whose per-pair bias does not cancel in an ordering and whose direction is indeterminate before the within-group dispersions are computed.

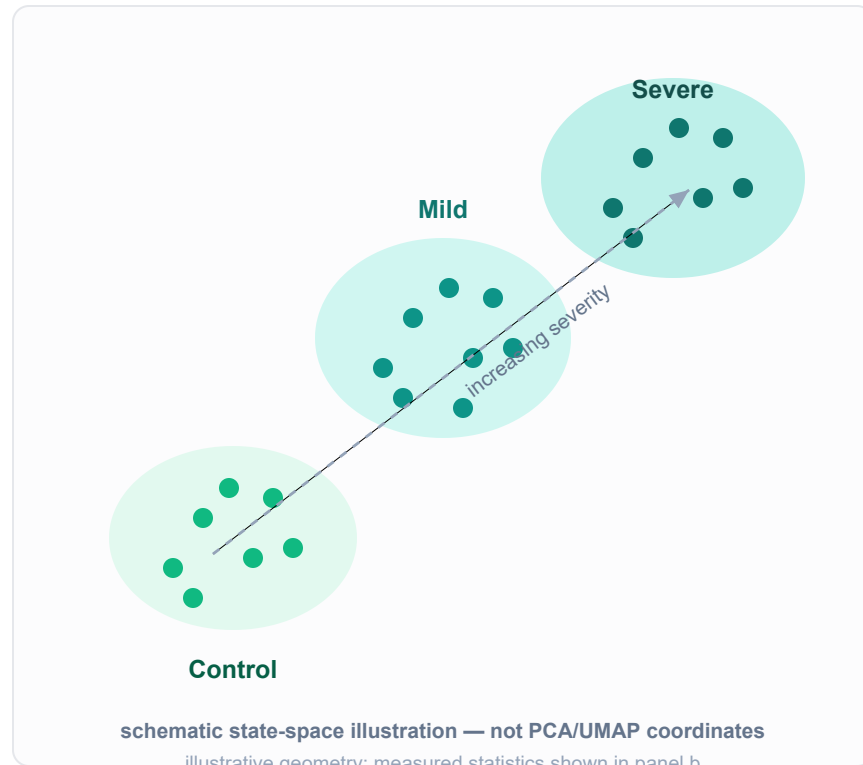
The published analysis also did not perform exhaustive leave-one-out: one maximum-norm sample was removed per group. 'Stable to removing any single sample' is withdrawn.

The figure is preserved unmodified on the following page and in git history. It is deliberately not rebuilt while an independent metric audit is pending.

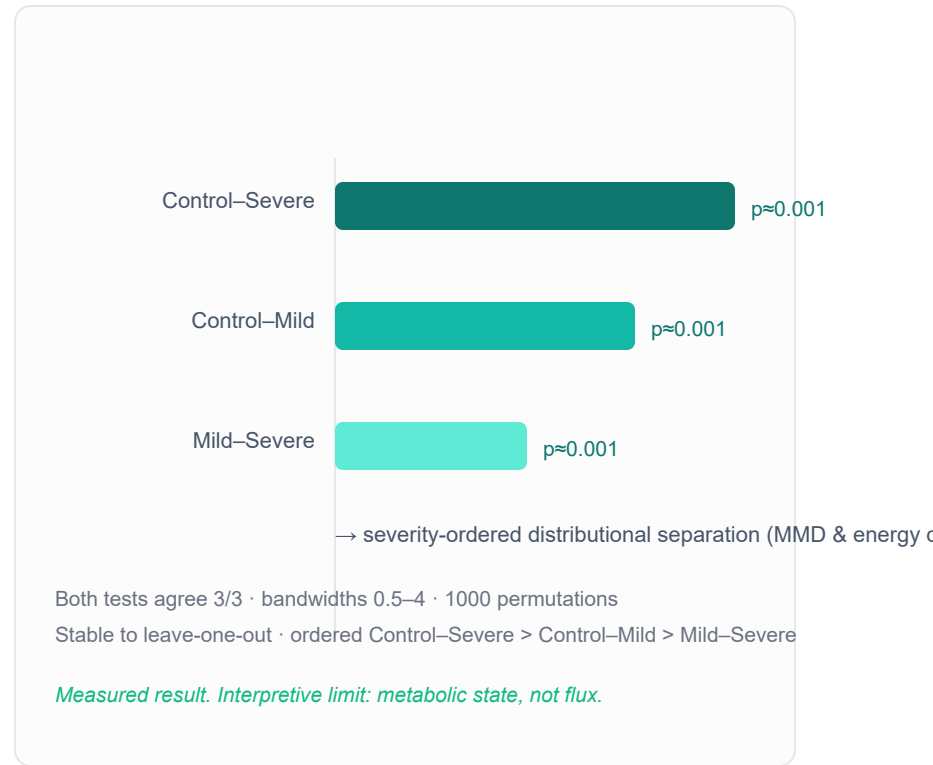
A separable metabolic state across COVID-19 severity

Human neutrophil metabolome (Li_ST002477) · 287 metabolites × 75 samples · Control 19 / Mild 30 / Severe 26

a · Severity groups occupy distinguishable metabolic states



b · Distributional separation is significant and severity-ordered



Bar lengths summarize the observed ordering of MMD and energy-distance results; they are not a new metric. Permutation-based $p \approx 0.001$ for all pairwise comparisons.

Figure 3 · measured result = the distributional separation · no flux, no causal claim, no clinical prediction

